



The Lake Forest Park Road Association Newsletter
Town of Sturgeon Bay, WI

*Published twice yearly
Autumn 2026*

President's Post

by David Wood (2810 LFPR)

president@lakeforestparkrd.org

The Summer of 2026 was a summer of extremes, with beautiful days interspersed with record breaking heat and Canadian wildfire smoke, then wrapping up with a glorious Labor Day weekend. Now the changing colors and crisp Fall air signal what comes next as we transition to the colder days ahead.

Fall also brings the last gathering of the calendar year: our annual Oktoberfest celebration, from 5-7 pm on Saturday, October 10 at the Sawyer Park Pavilion. A special thanks to Karen Zarse and Katina Daher for taking over the event this year! Please RSVP as soon as possible to Katina at katinadaher@comcast.net if you haven't already. As in the past few years, I will bring a keg of homebrewed beer to help celebrate (a full one, I promise!) Brats, chicken, salad, and cake provided. BYO drinks and (optionally) desserts or other food to share.

Fall also brings the UW-Oshkosh Fall Private Well Monitoring program, with an imminent signup deadline of October 9. See the flyer included in this newsletter. This program is incredibly important to understanding the impact of agricultural runoff on water quality. If you miss this program, the UW-Oshkosh lab is open year round, with pickups Monday-Friday from 8am-4pm and drop-offs Monday-Thursday from 8am-3pm. However, late results will not be included in the annual report reviewed by the DNR and legislators, so please participate in the well testing program if you can.

AT&T has officially finished installing the fiber optic infrastructure needed to support high speed broadband internet service to everyone in the Town of Sturgeon Bay. As of last week, they report having signed up 193 fiber customers, which is 21% of the township. Installation is currently free, so I strongly encourage everyone to sign up now. I believe that AT&T is cheaper and faster than every other alternative, and since there is no long-term contract, you can cancel after one month and keep the option to switch to them later without incurring an expensive installation cost. See the Broadband Article for additional information.

Please enjoy this issue of *Between Lake and Forest* and I hope to see you at Oktoberfest, or just along the road.



Committee News



Deepest thanks to **Jean Laundrie (3080 LFPR)**, who has served on the Welcome Committee for many seasons. She has decided to step down from the position.

Arlyn Lulewicz (3204 LFPR) will be joining the Welcome Committee and will be meeting and greeting newcomers to the road from May through October.

Dennis and Bonnie Connolly (2732 LFPR) will continue to manage the Committee through the remaining months of the year. If you know of new homeowners on the road, please contact a member of the Welcome Committee.

Additional special thanks go out to **Karen Zarse (2970 LFPR)** and **Katina Daher (3318 LFPR)** for taking over the Oktoberfest event this year. Your efforts are greatly appreciated!

It's Time to VOTE!

- **WHEN:** Tuesday, November 3, from 7 AM to 8 PM
Photo I.D. Required
- **WHERE:** Arle Memorial Hall (former K of C Hall), 692 Tacoma Beach Rd.
(For Town of Sturgeon Bay residents, i.e. Lake Forest Park Road residents)
- **NEW WISCONSIN VOTER?**
You can register online – MyVote.wi.gov
You can register on Election Day at your Polling Place – **you MUST provide Proof of Residence**
- **ABSENTEE?**
Request your ballot online – MyVote.wi.gov
Or via surface mail – Town of Sturgeon Bay, P.O. Box 542, Sturgeon Bay WI 54235
- **QUESTIONS?**
Town Clerk, Michelle Sternard at clerk@townofsturgeonbay-wi.gov
Phone: (920) 328-5246



LFPRA Events - Print Out & Save

DOG DAY

We meet at 10 am at the Shiloh Road Bark Park on the second Thursday of the month, as long as the fair weather holds.

- October 8
- November 12
- Dare we hope for December 10?

Rain dates on the following Fridays

LFPRA EVENTS

- **Octoberfest - Saturday, October 10, 5-7 pm, Sawyer Park Pavilion**
- **Winter Dinner - Saturday, January 16, 2027**
5 pm cocktails; 6 pm dinner, Nightingale Supper Club
- April 1, 2027 - newsletter articles DUE
- April 15, 2027 - newsletter distribution
- June 2027 (date TBD) - Annual Meeting

WOMEN'S BOOK GROUP at 5th & J COFFEEHOUSE

Meetings are at 10 am on the third Thursday of the month

- October 15
- November 19
- **December 17: 12 pm @ Bluefront Cafe - Holiday Lunch**

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2027!

- January 21
- February 18
- March 18

PICNICS IN PORTAGE PARK

See you next June!

Lake Forest Park Road Association Officers		
President	David Wood	president@lakeforestparkrd.org
Vice-President	Tom Bennett	vicepresident@lakeforestparkrd.org
Treasurer	Annette Vincent	treasurer@lakeforestparkrd.org
Board Member	Bob Brown	skybob70@yahoo.com
Board Member	Eileen Brown	ebrown3@aol.com
Board Member	Paul Lutzke	paullutzke@hotmail.com
Board Member	Pat Nell	patnell1914@gmail.com
Committees and Volunteers		
Adopt-a-Road	Hans and Carol Borcharding	hansborcharding@yanoo.com
	Paul Lutzke	paullutzke@hotmail.com
	Gina Morgan	gina3@charter.net
Broadband	Jeff Feuerstein	jefffeuerstein@hotmail.com
	David Wood	president@lakeforestparkrd.org
Directory/Database Manager	Jon Krainak	jonathan.krainak@gmail.com
Facebook Page	Kim Krueger	805shiva@gmail.com
Moderators	Paul Lutzke	paullutzke@hotmail.com
Historian	John Vincent	jsvco@sbcglobal.net
Newsletter Editor	Kim Krueger	805shiva@gmail.com
Octoberfest	Katina Daher NEW	katinadaher@comcast.net
	Karen Zarse NEW	zarsek@gmail.com
PiPP Signs	Jeff Feuerstein	jefffeuerstein@hotmail.com
	Paul Lutzke	paullutzke@hotmail.com
	Annette and John Vincent	jsvco@sbcglobal.net
	David Wood	president@lakeforestparkrd.org
Propane Representative	Rod Miller	roderickemiller@aol.com
Welcome Committee	Bonnie and Dennis Connolly	dconnoll@charter.net
	Arlyn Lulewicz NEW	arynal@gmail.com
Winter Dinner	Doug McGee	dpmcgee1925@charter.net

Broadband Expansion Wraps Up this Fall!

by David Wood (2810 LFPR)

AT&T has officially finished installing the fiber optic infrastructure needed to provide high-speed broadband to every household and business in the Town of Sturgeon Bay! AT&T's offering is superior to Spectrum and wireless providers like Starlink. It is significantly cheaper and provides incredibly fast, symmetric bandwidth (same speed uploading information as downloading it), which is important for high-quality video conferencing and transferring large photos, videos, and documents.

AT&T reports that 21% of households in the town have already signed up, taking advantage of (currently) free installation and an even lower introductory 12-month rate (\$15 less than the long-term rate). You can contact AT&T's regular sales team at (866) 335-1617 or <http://www.att.com> and select AT&T Fiber.

Alternatively, you can reach out to the regional sales team, who in my experience, are less responsive for initial installation but helpful in resolving more complex issues. AT&T and its contractors *should* restore any property damage in a timely fashion. If you have any concerns about property restoration, please contact Carol below.

Harrison Gorski, Residential Accounts: (608) 556-9069, Harrison.Gorski@att.com

Nick Frey, Business Accounts: (608) 332-6171, nf353d@att.com

Carol Anason, Network Project Manager: (608) 622-2079, ca2624@att.com



Road Directory Changes and Related News

While Jon Krainak and his team of expert proofreaders do their absolute best to ensure the accuracy of our printed Road Directory, sometimes things change at the last minute or slip through the cracks. **This is why it is *ESSENTIAL* that everyone fill out the online or paper information form every other year when asked to do so - even if you think nothing has changed in 30 years.** We're *really* not trying to bug you. Your cooperation is appreciated. Please take note of the following changes.

Susan Eckhardt's home at (3070 LFPR) (once occupied by her mom **Sandy Johnson**) has been listed for sale as of September 2026. Good luck, Susan, in your new adventures!

The **JoAnn Hilgenberg** home at (2836 LFPR) has a contact change. The primary contact is Jim Hilgenberg, 6245 Eagle Ridge Road, Bettendorf, IA, 52722. Cell number is (563) 343-6425.

OKTOBERFEST!

Katina Daher (3318 LFPR) and **Karen Zarse (2970 LFPR)**, the **new** Oktoberfest Committee, are pleased to invite you to this year's celebration at the Sawyer Park Pavilion. Please join us! A **BIG** thank you to Katina and Karen for masterminding this event!



Oktoberfest
October 10, 2026
Sawyer Park Pavillion
S Neenah Ave, Sturgeon Bay
5 -7 pm

Menu: Brats, chicken, salads, and cake.

BYO drinks. Water is available. **And BEER** (thank you David)

If you could help decorate, come early.

If you could help clean up, stay a bit later.

If you would like to bring cookies or another dessert, thank you.

RSVP to Katina Daher
katinadaher@comcast.net

Winter Dinner

Come one, come all to the annual Winter Dinner - a chance to make merry and shake off those post-holiday blues.

Join us on **Saturday, January 16, 2027** at the **Nightingale Supper Club**.

Cocktails are at 5:00 followed by dinner from a special menu at 6:00.

It's a fun evening, so please attend!

Mark your calendars and RSVP to **Doug McGee (3268 LFPR)** at dpmcgee1925@charter.net or (920) 743-8684 by January 9, 2027.



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SEPTEMBER 2

In the evening there were flocks of nighthawks
passing southward over the valley. The tall
sunflowers stood, burning on their stalks
to cold seed, by the still river. And high
up the birds rose into sight against the darkening
clouds. They tossed themselves among the fading
landscapes of the sky like rags, as in
abandonment to the summons their blood knew.
And in my mind, where had stood a garden
straining to the light, there grew
an acceptance of decline. Having worked,
I would sleep, my leaves all dissolved in flight.

Wendell Berry, *Poetry Magazine*, May 1970
poetryfoundation.org

Neighbors in the News



In case you missed it, some of our neighbors were recently highlighted in local media outlets.

Bonnie Connolly's (2732 LFPR) artwork *Milkweed* earned a Juror's Choice Award in the 51st Juried Annual Exhibition, now on view at the Miller Art Museum through November 7. The annual exhibition has grown from a small local show to a statewide retrospective celebrating excellence in the visual arts. Of 317 submissions, only 64 works were chosen for the show.

Congratulations to **Bonnie!**

Door County Living magazine featured an article about **Jeff and Donna Feuerstein (2500 Canal Road)** and their renovation of the North Pierhead Lighthouse, which they now own. The **Feuersteins** have been working diligently to repair the catwalk and the lighthouse itself, which now sports a brand new bright red coat of paint. They have created a unique and welcoming space, but it does require some high climbing.

You can take a virtual tour of the property via YouTube: <https://fb.watch/v/3ulyLC44s/?fs=e>. Follow the next adventures of the Lighthouse on Facebook at: <https://www.facebook.com/profile.php?id=61590425150839>



Have news to share?

Let your Newsletter Editor know!
Email me **anytime** with stories, photos, etc. and I'll keep them on hand for the next issue of the newsletter.

Kim Krueger 805shiva@gmail.com

Fall 2026 Propane Update

by Rod Miller (5087 CTH TT)

The LFPR Board has decided to once again select Ferrellgas as our recommended propane vendor for the 2026-2027 heating season. Their supply agreement was finalized and signed July 20, 2026.

Ferrellgas once again proposed the most competitive offer. They have been serving our area for many years and have an outstanding reputation for service. Below are the highlights of their offer.

- Term is 8/1/2026 thru 8/31/2027.
- Fixed price is \$1.569 per gallon (a \$.02/gallon increase).
- No delivery charge and no Fuel Surcharge.
- Free lease of tanks owned by Ferrellgas; 1000-gallon tanks require purchasing 1200 gallons per year or lease is \$80.
- Free system test upon change over and free change out of competitor's tank.
- Pump over fee is \$99 (no charge if your existing tank is less than 50%).
- Free tank monitors and free tank monitoring.

We also received proposals from Lakes Gas and AmeriGas. Their proposal details are summarized below.

Lakes Gas

Lakes Gas has also offered a competitive proposal for the 2026-2027 heating season. Lakes Gas has been serving our area for many years and has an outstanding reputation for service with a fully staffed office in Sturgeon Bay. Lakes Gas does not require our Association to sign a purchase agreement. Our members simply identify themselves as a member of the Lake Forest Park Road Association. Below are the highlights of their offer.

- Term is July 1, 2026 thru June 30, 2027.
- Price is \$1.799 per gallon.
- No delivery fees.
- Free lease of tanks owned by Lakes Gas.
- Free Leased Tank Swap (pump over fee is waived).
- Free tank monitoring.

AmeriGas

AmeriGas has the least competitive offer for the 2026-2027 heating season. In July, AmeriGas agreed to honor their proposed price of \$1.95 per gallon for existing customers, without a contract from our association. In August, AmeriGas decided to require a contract with our association as a condition to honor the \$1.95 per gallon price. Consequently, all existing AmeriGas customers in our association will pay the current market price per gallon for the 2026-2027 heating season, plus delivery fees. We apologize for any inconvenience this may have caused our association members, but we could not sign a contract with AmeriGas having previously signed a supply contract with Ferrellgas.

Propane Update, continued

The opportunity to participate in the special negotiated price for the purchase of LP Gas is one of the benefits of LFPR Association Membership. Participation is completely voluntary, and it is the responsibility of the homeowner to contract directly with the propane vendor of your choice.

Please remember, it is important that our association members contact their preferred supplier directly for all additional terms and conditions and sign a supply contract for the 2026-2027 heating season.

Propane Suppliers Contact information

Ferrellgas: Existing customers should contact customer service at (715) 524-2137 or (800) 530-0113.

For new customers switching to Ferrellgas please email Katie Monfre at katiemonfre@ferrellgas.com or Doug Harrer at dougharrer@ferrellgas.com.

Mention the LFPR Association membership and your contact information in your email, and Katie or Doug will route your request to a customer service representative who will call you back and set up your new account.

Lakes Gas: Chuck Blessman; cblessman@lakesgas.com or call (920) 743-5704 and speak to Danelle or Chuck.

AmeriGas: Email kacie.Alloy@amerigas.com

If you have any further questions or comments, please reach out to Rod Miller.

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Spring Well Monitoring Program Results

by David Wood (2810 LFPR)

president@lakeforestparkrd.org

In cased you missed it - you may view the well monitoring results via these links to the slide deck and video presentation.

- [2026 Spring UW-Oshkosh Presentation of Door County Well Monitoring Program \(pdf\)](#)
- [2026 Spring UW-Oshkosh Recorded Presentation of Door County Well Monitoring Program](#)

Update from *Concerned Citizens for Responsible Agriculture*

by Rod Miller (5087 CTH TT) and Annette Vincent (2794 LFPR)

BACKGROUND & HISTORY

Our working group, officially named *Concerned Citizens for Responsible Agriculture*, was initially organized to create community awareness of the Gilbert Farms Ltd. request to expand their operation at 5186 CTH T to over 2,400 animal units. A dairy farm operating with over 1,000 animal units (with a few exceptions) is considered a CAFO (Concentrated Animal Feeding Operation). The rules governing CAFOs are codified in the Wisconsin Administrative Code NR 243. The Wisconsin Department of Natural Resources (WDNR) is the agency that applies, interprets, and enforces those rules and regulations through the WPDES (Wisconsin Pollutant Discharge Elimination System) permitting process. Dairy farms under 1,000 animal units are regulated by the county.

As you have probably heard, the WDNR approved the WPDES permit for Gilbert Farms Ltd. The permit is effective July 1, 2026 and expires June 30, 2031. This approval gives the farm a green light to expand to 2,430 animal units. Based on public comments at the Public Informational Hearing held on November 5, 2025, and written comments submitted to the WDNR, a few modifications were made to the permit as follows:

- Monitoring well requirements at the production facility were moved up to 2026 (previously 2029).
- Acknowledgement of the sinkhole in the production area and related monitoring of Waste Storage Facilities 1 & 2 for surrounding ground water saturation.
- Commencing with the 2028 Nutrient Management Plan (NMP), the NMP must include off-site monitoring of potential nitrogen loss to groundwater.

The WPDES permit applies only to water quality protection. The permit rules do not give the WDNR authority to address air quality, odor, truck traffic, land use, disease control, carcass removal, abandonment costs, or any of the social concerns our community has about factory farms. DNR oversight is stretched thin; Wisconsin has roughly 346 CAFOs, about 33 billion pounds of waste per year, and required inspections occur closer to every five years than every three years. So, to a large extent, compliance with the WPDES permit relies on self-monitoring and self-reporting by the CAFO.

WATER QUALITY MONITORING

In response to the lack of monitoring by the WDNR, our working group has established a water quality testing program. The following bodies of water are currently being monitored:

- Lily Bay Creek (at Forest Rd. and Country View Rd.)
- Big Creek (at Michigan St. and/or just north of Utah St.)
- Copper Creek (at Ridge Rd. and/or entrance to Lake Michigan)
- Geisel Creek (at Haberli Rd.)
- Kellner Fen (northeast side, southwest side and the ditch at LFPR)

The above creeks were chosen due to their proximity to the Gilbert Farms production area and the farm's manure spreading fields.

Update from *Concerned Citizens for Responsible Agriculture* (continued)

We tested for fecal coliform and *E. coli* bacteria using UW-Oshkosh IDEXX testing available during the summer from Crossroads at Big Creek. We also tested for nitrates, nitrites, and ammonia levels using test strips. Analysis of nitrate/nitrite water sampling was also performed by UW-Oshkosh through Crossroads.

Kellner Fen tested very high on the IDEXX tests for *E. coli* and fecal coliform. However, IDEXX tests can give false positive results, which requires further DNA source testing of the samples. Our qPCR DNA source testing indicates that Kellner Fen does NOT contain *E. coli* or fecal contamination at this point. It is growing large amounts of other microorganisms which can generate the false positive result, so it is important to be careful with pets and children near the ditch outlet of Kellner Fen into Lake Michigan along the beach (3160 LFPR). Spring flooding may have added to the growth of microorganisms.

Copper Creek has repeatedly tested at fecal coliform maximum and at *E. coli* levels that would trigger beach warnings or closures (1000MPN/100ml). Subsequent qPCR testing indicates that this contamination is indeed *E. coli*, a fecal indicator bacteria. However, it is likely of human and chicken origin, as those species' DNA were detected with the *E. coli* DNA. Bovine DNA was not detected in this sample. Copper Creek also has elevated nitrates on several tests (3-6 mg/L range). We will be following up with the Door County Soil and Water Department in the hope that they can make an effort to track the source of the contamination (possibly septic system leakage or dumping upstream). Extreme caution for pets and children is urged at the outlet of Copper Creek into Lake Michigan (3190-3200 LFPR) until this is resolved.

Lily Bay Creek has repeatedly tested at fecal coliform maximum and at *E. coli* levels that would trigger beach warnings (above 235MPN/100ml). Subsequent qPCR testing also indicates that this contamination is *E. coli* and probably of human origin. Nitrates are in the 1-4 mg/L range. Lily Bay Boat Launch Beach near the mouth of Lily Bay Creek has had a few beach warnings in the past, so the Door County Soil and Water Department will be informed of our results.

Big Creek in the Crossroads preserve has generally tested lower for fecal contamination than the other creeks. It has tested once at fecal coliform maximum and slight *E. coli* levels on the IDEXX test. We did not conduct a qPCR test. However, it consistently has had elevated nitrates above 6mg/L. In general, elevated nitrate levels are indicative of excess nutrient runoff from agricultural sources.

Additional testing activities are planned for the fall manure spreading season if we can find a convenient testing center to process our samples.

Fall Well Monitoring Program

Note that a response is due by OCTOBER 9



UWO UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN
OSHKOSH

Fall 2026 DOOR COUNTY PRIVATE WELL MONITORING PROGRAM

TESTING PARAMETERS

-  Total coliforms/*E. coli* (quantification)
-  Nitrate (Nitrate + nitrite as N)

Cost is only \$30*

**Discounted rate for the first 300 registrants; \$45 for those registering after the first 300 registrants.*

Optional arsenic, pH, alkalinity, hardness and iron tests available at an additional cost of \$25

ABOUT THE PROGRAM

The University of WI Oshkosh has been offering discounted well water quality testing through this program since 2019. The goal of this program is to provide education about the importance of testing your well water as well as build a database of groundwater quality data in Door County.

HOW IT WORKS

- RSVP using the link or QR code below by October 9th
- Receive sampling kit in mail
- Return your kit October 23rd & 24th at designated drop-off locations
- Receive your results & countywide summary of study



Registration accepted through October 9th

RSVP online at uwo.sh/doorco-wells-fall26 or using the QR code

**Prepayment using a credit card is accepted when you RSVP online, otherwise mailed checks are accepted made out to UW Oshkosh. Note that sampling kits will not be mailed out until payment is received.*

Sample drop-off is October 23rd & 24th – mark your calendars!

For more information, contact Jackie Behrens at eric@uwosh.edu or (920) 424-3148

Town of Sturgeon Bay News

by Jeff Feuerstein, Town Chair (2500 Canal Road)

Before becoming a member of the Town of Sturgeon Bay Board, I was the LFPR Association President for 7 or so years. I'll stop way short of calling it a job. It was a great way to meet folks and help plan a few events to encourage camaraderie on the road. I gave it up when stepped in to fill a vacancy on the Town Board.

The Town Board job expands the footprint of folks I serve, and also puts me in contact with various State, County, and other resources. Because of the work of the Board, our costs and the resulting taxes are much, much lower than those in the city of Sturgeon Bay. We have actually been approached by several residents on the border about detaching from the city and joining the Town. We would welcome them, but so far the city has never been willing to approve their request.

The public is always invited to attend the monthly Town meetings on the **second Tuesday at 6 pm at Arle Hall**. Please go to the Town website to sign up for notices when agendas, minutes, or other info is posted. <https://townofsturgeonbay-wi.gov/>

Recent projects the Town has completed include: the Fall road tour, the completion of AT&T broadband infrastructure, and working with Sheriffs' Department to enforce the County nuisance ordinance for noise where there has been an issue.

Some ongoing work we are reviewing at residents' request are considerations for Dark Sky and Surface Water Quality.

From time to time, the Town will post "help wanted" requests, like poll workers or committee members, and thanks so much to those that have answered the call. It is a great way to learn more and meet fellow Town members. There will be more opportunities in the future.

We may be looking for a new Town Chair next year. I still want to be on the Board, but at a lesser capacity like Supervisor. My wife, Donna, retired earlier this year and we want to do a little more traveling. One of the existing Supervisors may step up. We do have a great team now and would like to keep the group together, but if not, there may be opportunities available.

We have a great Town and an even greater road. Let's keep it that way and make it even better, safer, and enjoyable. It's an honor to serve. Please contact me if I can answer a question or assist.

Summertime Photos

Kids and PiPPs and kegs -- Oh my!

Despite a cold/hot/smoky/weird kind of summer, we made the best of it!

At left, Ryder, a grandson of the Garritys; and scenes from the August PiPP and Dog Day.



The Dog Days of Summer

Dogs and their two-legged friends had a doggone good time gathering at the Shiloh Road Bark Park this summer. We will continue meeting on the **second Thursday of the month at 10 am** as long as the weather holds. (Rain date is the following Friday.) Please bring your sociable dogs and join us!



Luke Kusche, checking out the scene



Morris Bennett, looking regal



Winnie Janning, getting much deserved pets



Dexter Krueger, basking



Ziva with John Vincent; Luke with John Kusche

LFPRA Third Thursday Women's Book Group

by Members of the Women's Book Group, edited by Kim Krueger

The women's book group meets on the **third Thursday** of the month at **5th and Jefferson Coffeehouse** at **10:00 a.m.** If you are a female resident of the road and would like to join us, please email **Donna Janning** at dwjanning@gmail.com. Here's our latest book report.



Illustration credit: Clare Schneider, NPR

April 2026: All the Broken Places by John Boyne

Well, "April is the cruellest month", wrote T.S. Eliot, and so it proved to be. We were overcome by the floodwaters of spring (or we were still snow-birding, or we were feeling poorly), so only one devoted reader showed up at the coffeehouse. Some of us enjoyed this very thoughtful story. It was a poignant reminder of how the trauma of war endures for many generations even after the fighting stops. The book raised some difficult questions: Can a powerless minor child be complicit in genocide? Can one ever atone for such a crime? Is an act of violence acceptable if it will save another's life? Much to think about in this historical novel.

May 2026: How to Age Disgracefully: a Novel by Clare Pooley

A big thanks to Ruth Sandor for recommending a book we would not have read otherwise. We all decided there is real value in that! Although it seemed to some of us to be a young adult book, it had many fun moments and some great examples of how a multigenerational and multicultural group can come together for common good in the community, and also learn and grow with each other. We all self-identified (more than we wanted to admit) with the character of Daphne, who made us both laugh and cry. All in all, a lighthearted, enjoyable book that was a refreshing break from some of the more serious books on our plate this year.

June 2026: Wild Dark Shore by Charlotte McConaghy

Six of us had a very lively discussion on Wild Dark Shore and concluded it was an enjoyable (if melodramatic) family saga/mystery with many narrative threads: parenting, grief, climate disaster, nature, the harshness of the sea and its creatures, and the ultimate human sacrifice for a loved one. Certainly it provided one more reminder of our fragile planet and the urgency needed to protect it. Worth reading.

July 2026: Running with Sherman by Christopher McDougall

We all agreed that this story of a rehabilitated donkey reminded us to be tenacious and never give up; and of the value of being part of a community and helping others as well as being able to ask for help. Animals can teach us how to be better people, and can offer the power of healing. While it might not have been a "first choice" book, it was certainly worthwhile. As so often happens in this group we drift in many conversational directions during our gatherings and that's something that makes the group enjoyable. Hang in there and keep moving forward like Sherman!

LFPRA Third Thursday Women's Book Group (continued)

August 2026: Circle of Days by Ken Follett

A large group turnout had a fun time expressing our views on this "prehistorical" novel. Our takes: Negatives: Much too long and seemed historically inaccurate. Ahistorical phrasing which likely didn't exist in Paleolithic times (though who would know?!) Not written like other Follett books which we thought were good; this one felt flat and like it could have been written by AI. Positives: Technically interesting information on the dawn of mathematics, the calendar, and construction techniques. The narrative was a great example of how humans have not changed much over 3000 years. We are still mean to each other, racist, beat our children, and can't get along with each other! Yet we are happiest when connected with a partner, family, and a community that works together helping each other. Those of us that made it to the finish line (this one was a brick!) agreed it was again good to read something we would not have chosen otherwise.

September 2026: John of John by Douglas Stuart

Stuart's Shuggie Bain won the 2020 Booker Prize. Not everyone got through this book, and all agreed it was "not for everyone." Those of us who did finish appreciated the good writing and character development, especially that of the grandmother, who provides welcome comic relief. Grandma's "Presbyterian values" are key to understanding the religious rigidity of 1990s Scotland, which shaped the complex father/son relationship in this novel. We enjoyed learning about the Harris Tweed hand-weaving industry, which was beautifully described. Eleanor Dean, who has been to Scotland many times, filled us in on Scottish history and the difficult time during The Clearances when sheep were valued more than people. She recommended the Outlander book series for further exploration.



Upcoming Books

- October 2026: Culpability by Bruce Holsinger
- November 2026: Family of Spies: A World War II Story of Nazi Espionage, Betrayal, and the Secret History Behind Pearl Harbor by Christine Kuehn
- **December 17, 2026: Holiday Lunch @ Bluefront at 12:00 p.m.** Please read The Road to Tender Hearts by Annie Hartnett

Local History: Stay Tuned!

by John Vincent (2794 LFPR)

Local History will return in a future issue, once John has dug himself out from under his other projects!



"The Idiom" (Infinite Book Tower)
by Matej Kren, 1998,
Municipal Library of Prague

The Unnamed Creek

by Emily Baker (3244 LFPR)

Emily Baker writes on Substack as *The Writer on the Water*.



On our road there is an unnamed creek. In summertime, it is overgrown with leafy foliage, just inches deep, and likely unnoticed by most who wander by it. Before this year, I had thought nothing of it, the water often being shallow and stagnant. Until one April morning, halfway through my morning dog walk, I was stopped in the middle of the road right where the creek runs underneath through a handful of small culverts.

The street had transformed. The snowmelt and historic rainfall converged, and it was too much water for the drainage system. Instead, that sleepy and still unnamed creek was a gushing river, overflowing the street in an ankle-deep flood. And I, having moved to Door County from a desert climate, was elated.

I had never seen so much water! Like a little kid on Christmas, I stomped right into the flow and began to splash around, much to the disappointment of my two dogs. But it was more than just the spectacle of it all. It was the beauty of getting to see the fragile and unique ecosystem of the Door County peninsula at work.

Months prior, I had watched for the first time as the temperature dropped, the trees were stripped bare of their leaves, and the water of our Lake Michigan shoreline receded, revealing a mosaic of rocks underneath. Being my first winter, I wondered if this was normal or if I was witnessing the impacts of manmade water depletion. But then on that April day, the water returned. It roared down that little unnamed creek directly into the lake, slowly pushing the waterline back up the rocks until they were once again hidden for the summer.

With the snowmelt came the arrival of the sucker fish, another phenomenon I witnessed for the first time. Hiding in shadows and near rocks, these fish were all hanging out in that same creek; temporary residents of our little Door County road. These fish play an instrumental role in our ecosystem: laying eggs that provide essential nutrients and food to promote healthy spring growth in the rivers that then provide food for insects, who in turn become food for other fish, birds, and larger animals crucial to the ecosystem here.

All of that occurs in this previously unnoticed creek on my road. A creek which, had I never moved to Door County to see all four seasons unfold, I never would have known the crucial role it plays, despite its small size.